informed Headley of the need to postpone the Northern Project in response to this pressure.[78] The result was to push him deeper into Kashmiri's orbit, and, through him, into al-Qaeda's orbit as well. Headley told investigators that he had doubts about Lashkar's leaders as a result, describing them as 'coward[s] and pliable.'[79] Yet, Headley did not break his ties with Lashkar. Instead, like other members troubled by the leadership's conservatism, he kept one foot inside and the other outside of the group. Meanwhile, Sajid continued to rely on Headley even after it became clear he was pursing the Northern Project in concert with Syed, and through him with Kashmiri, in direct contravention of Lashkar's instructions.

Abdur Rehman took Headley to North Waziristan once again in May. Kashmiri was much more enthusiastic, telling him the 'elders', whom Headley understood to be al-Qaeda's leadership, were anxious for the attack to take place as soon as possible. He was given $1,500, told to return to Denmark post-haste and take more videos. Kashmiri also provided contact details for several operatives in Europe, directing Headley to inform them the operation should be a suicide attack for which the terrorists needed to prepare martyrdom videos.[80] Headley first returned to the US, where he continued to correspond with Abdur Rehman and Sajid. By this time Lashkar had 'got clearance to launch another attack' against what Headley believed was an economic target in Gujarat.[81] Sajid wanted him to travel to India immediately, but he demurred. The Northern Project came first. In late summer Headley visited Denmark once more, conducting a second round of surveillance, as well as traveling to the United Kingdom and Sweden to meet with Kashmiri's contacts.[82] Unbeknownst to Headley, the British security services were keeping the operatives whom he met under surveillance. 'David the American,' as he was known, was now on their radar.[83]

Headley's detection by the British security services ultimately led to his downfall, and to the wealth of information he provided regarding Lashkar's operations. Sajid seems to have known Headley was playing with fire, and in doing so exposing the group to potential risks. This became apparent when Syed was detained in Pakistan in late spring, two months before Headley exposed himself to British intelligence. When Sajid corresponded with Headley following the latter's trip to Denmark, he warned that Abdur Rehman might be 'singing,' but lamented that his advice was futile 'coz